



Unit 7

Clauses

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Lesson 7.1

Clauses



7.1 Clauses

We learned that a **phrase** is a group of words that acts as a part of speech, cannot stand alone as a sentence, and does not have both a subject and a predicate.

✎ Like a phrase, a **clause** is a group of words, but it has **both** a **subject** and a **predicate (verb)**. There are two types of **clauses**. These are **independent clauses** and **dependent clauses**.



7.1 Clauses

✎ An **independent clause** (main clause) expresses a **complete thought** and can stand alone as a **sentence**.

- We **ate** popcorn.
- I **will write** a report.
- Marta **flew** to Europe.

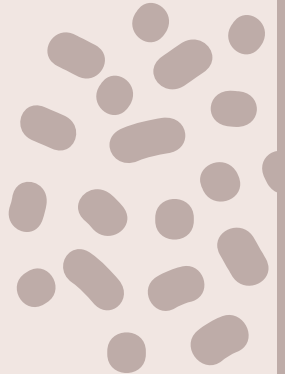
In these examples, each **clause** contains both a *subject* and a *predicate (verb)* and expresses a **complete thought**.



7.1 Clauses

✎ A **dependent clause** (subordinate clause) contains a **subject** and a **verb**, but it **cannot** stand alone as a sentence. It is **dependent** upon other parts of the sentence to express a complete thought.

A **dependent clause** is introduced by either a **relative pronoun** or a **subordinating conjunction**.



7.1 Clauses

✎ **Relative pronouns** are words such as **who, whom, whose, which, or that**.

✎ **Subordinating conjunctions** are words such as **after, although, as, because, before, if, since, unless, than, until, when, where, or while**. These are only a few examples.



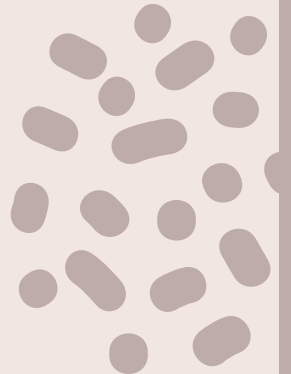
SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS

after
although
as
as if
as long as
as much as
as soon as
as though

because
before
even if
even though
how
if
in as much as
in order that

lest
now that
provided
since
so that
than
that
though

till
unless
until
when
whenever
where
wherever
while



7.1 Clauses

- *That* **we** made
- *After* **I** finish this book
- *When* **she** was a child

In these examples, each **clause** contains both a **subject** and a **predicate (verb)**, but they do **not** express a complete thought. The first example begins with the relative pronoun **that**. The other examples begin with the subordinating conjunctions **after** and **when**.



7.2

Structure of Sentences



7.2 Structure of Sentences

✎ Sentences are often grouped according to their structure. A sentence can be **simple**, **compound**, **complex**, or **compound-complex**.

A **simple sentence** contains **one independent clause**.

A **compound sentence** contains **2 or more independent clauses** that are usually **joined** by a **comma** and a **coordinating conjunction**.



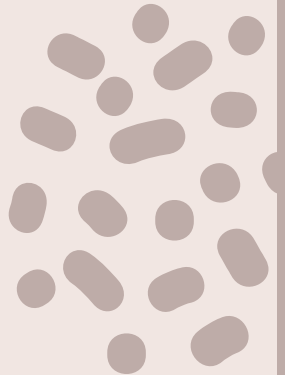
7.2 Structure of Sentences

✎ A **complex sentence** contains **one independent clause** and at least **one dependent clause** and at least one dependent clause introduced by either a **subordinating conjunction** or a **relative pronoun**.

We ate popcorn that we made.

I will write a report after I finish this book.

(**Independent clause**/ dependent clause)



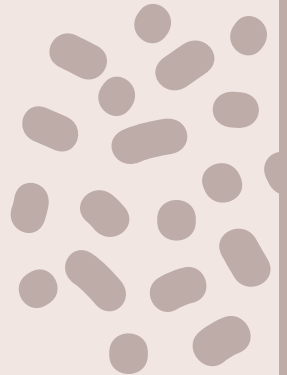
7.2 Structure of Sentences

✎ **Dependent clauses** occur at the **beginning**, the **middle**, or the **end** of a sentence.

A **comma** usually follows a **dependent clause** that **begins** a sentence.

After I finish this book, I will write a report.

When she was a child, Marta flew to Europe.

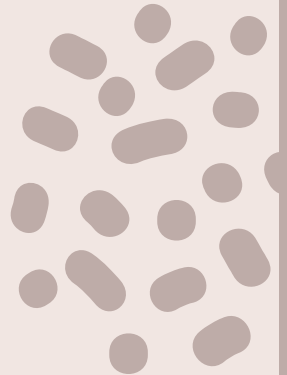


7.2 Structure of Sentences

Commas usually set off a dependent clause placed in the middle of a sentence.

Rob, whose uncle is a doctor, went to medical school.

My father, while he made dinner, sang a song.

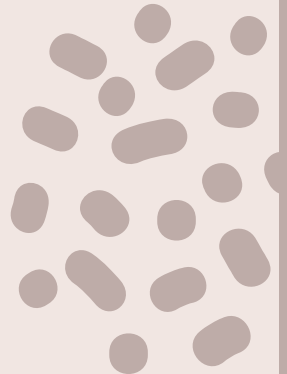


7.2 Structure of Sentences

If the **dependent clause ends** the sentence, a comma usually does **not** set it off.

I will write a report **after** I finish this book.

Marta flew to Europe **when** she was a child.



7.2 Structure of Sentences

✎ A **compound-complex sentence** contains **two or more independent clauses** and **one or more dependent clauses** (subordinate clauses).

Put a **comma** after the **dependent clause** if it begins the sentence. Also, put a **comma** before the **coordinating conjunction** that connects the **two independent clauses**.

Since it had stopped, Tom could not hear the radio, and he was upset.

Dependent clause/Independent clause



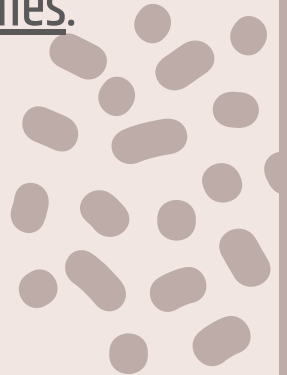
7.2 Structure of Sentences

More examples:

Scott went to the movies, but Sara stayed at home **because she felt ill.**

After Mom arrived, we ate a delicious dinner, and we played fun games.

Mary slipped **while she was running**, and she hurt her leg.



7.2 Structure of Sentences

✎ When writing sentences, beware of **misplaced modifiers**. When **modifiers** are too far away from the word they are supposed to modify, the sentence can be **confusing** or **awkward**.

Misplaced Modifier: I found my **ring** under the *chair* that had been lost.

Correct: Under the chair I found my **ring** that had been lost.



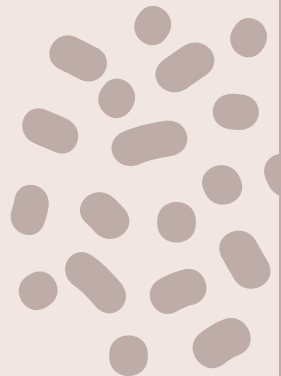
7.2 Structure of Sentences

✎ Another thing to watch out for is **dangling modifiers**. This happens when the modifying phrase or clause is not clearly related to the word it is next to.

Unlike a misplaced modifier, you **cannot** simply move it to a different place in a sentence. You need to add a **subject** to correct the sentence.

Dangling Modifier: Running for a taxi, my *hat* fell in the mud.

Correct: As I was running for a taxi, my hat fell in the mud.



7.2 Structure of Sentences

More examples:

Misplaced modifier: He gave the **gift** to his friend which he had wrapped earlier.

Correct: He gave the **gift** which he had wrapped earlier to his friend.

Misplaced modifier: **Carol** found her dog walking home from the store.

Correct: Walking home from the store, **Carol** found her dog.



7.2 Structure of Sentences

More examples:

Dangling Modifier: The smoke alarm went off while cooking our dinner.

Correct: The smoke alarm went off while **Dan** was cooking our dinner.

Dangling modifier: Having finished the assignment, the TV was turned on.

Correct: Having finished the assignment, **I** turned on the TV.



7.3

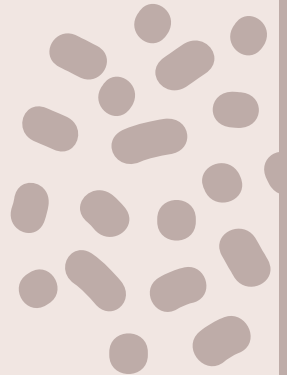
Adjective Clauses



7.3 Adjective Clauses

✎ There are **three** types of **dependent clauses**:

- **Adjective clauses**
- **Adverb clauses**
- **Noun clauses**



7.3 Adjective Clauses

✎ An **adjective clause (relative clause)** is a **dependent clause** used as an **adjective**. It follows the **noun** or **pronoun** it modifies and starts with a **relative pronoun** such as **who, whom, whose, which, or that**.

The shoes **that he bought today** were too small.

The adjective clause **that he bought today** modifies the noun **shoes** by telling **which shoes** were too small. We know it is a **clause** because it has a **subject (he)** and a **verb (bought)**. It modifies a **noun (shoes)**.



7.3 Adjective Clauses

✎ An **adjective clause** can be either **nonrestrictive (nonessential)** or **restrictive (essential)**.

✎ A **nonrestrictive adjective clause** is **not** essential to the meaning of the sentence. It gives information that is **not** crucial and can be **omitted** without affecting the meaning of the sentence. **Commas** are required to set off a **nonrestrictive adjective clause** from the rest of the sentence.



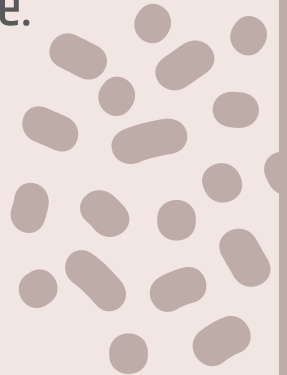
7.3 Adjective Clauses

Bobby Smith, **who is extremely tall**, ate quickly.

This **adjective clause** is **nonrestrictive** because the information in the clause does **not** restrict or limit the noun **Bobby Smith**. The fact that **Bobby Smith** is **extremely tall** has nothing to do with the meaning of the sentence.

Bobby Smith ate quickly.

The meaning of the sentence is still clear **without** the clause.



7.3 Adjective Clauses

✎ A **restrictive adjective clause** is essential to the meaning of the sentence. Without it, the basic meaning of the sentence is affected. A **restrictive adjective clause** gives information needed to identify the person or thing it is modifying.

The shoes ***that he bought today*** were too small.

The **adjective clause** is essential to the meaning of the sentence. In other words, if this clause is removed, the sentence's meaning will **not** be the same.



7.4

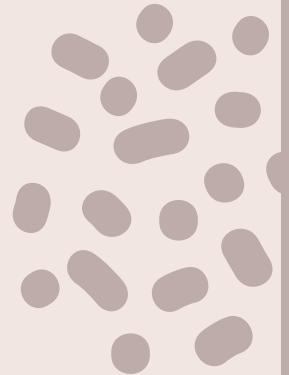
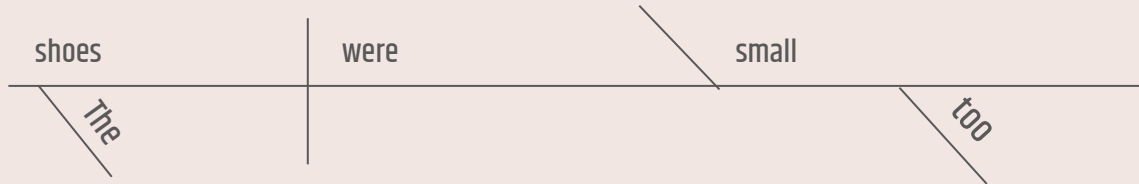
Diagramming Adjective Clauses



7.4 Diagramming Adjective Clauses

✎ Before we diagram an **adjective clause**, we must first **diagram** the **independent clause (main clause)**.

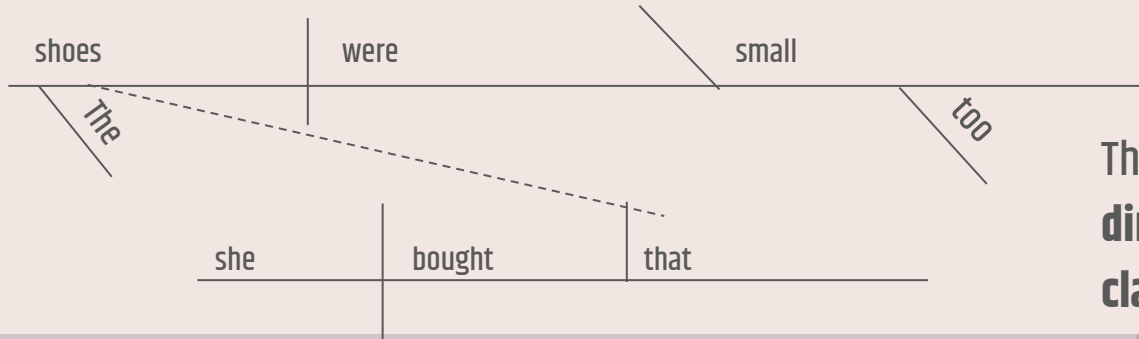
The shoes *that she bought* were too small.



7.4 Diagramming Adjective Clauses

✎ Diagram the adjective clause on a horizontal line below the independent clause. After determining the relative pronoun's function within the adjective clause, a dotted line connects the relative pronoun to the word it describes in the independent clause.

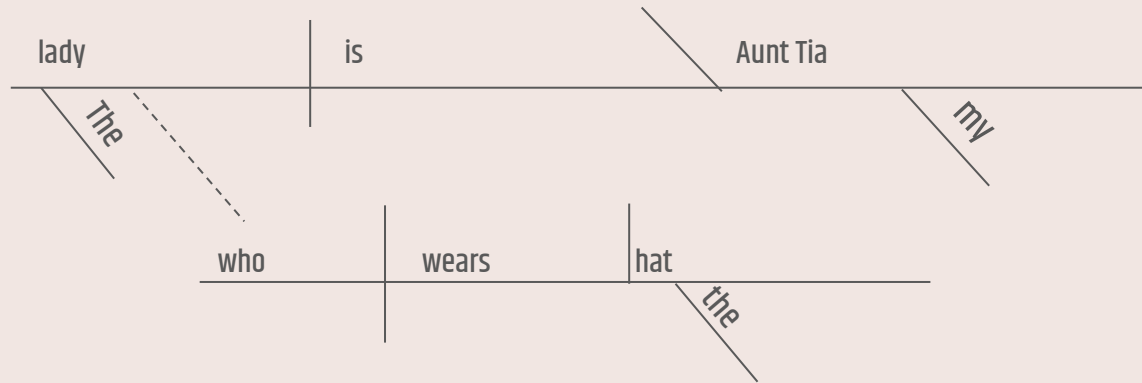
The shoes ***that she bought*** were too small.



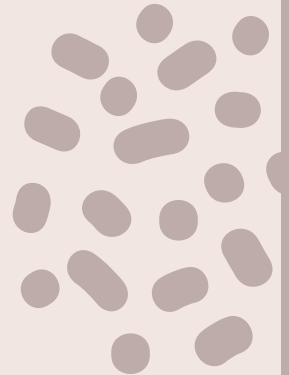
The relative pronoun **that** is the **direct object** in the **adjective clause**.

7.4 Diagramming Adjective Clauses

The lady **who wears the hat** is my Aunt Tia.

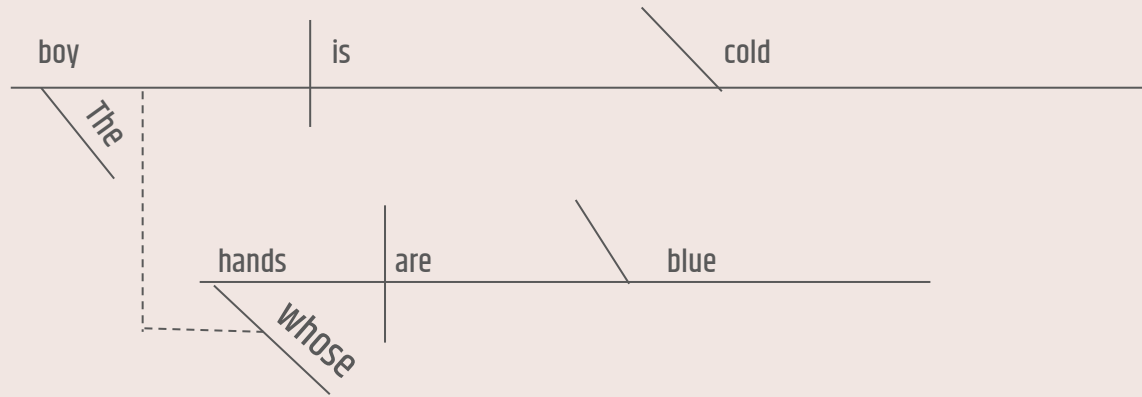


Who is the **subject** in this **adjective clause**.

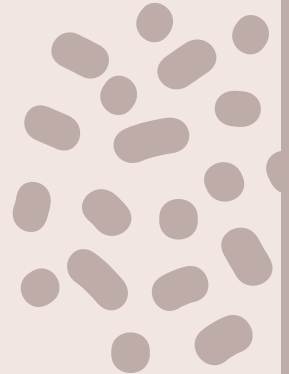


7.4 Diagramming Adjective Clauses

The boy **whose hands are blue** is cold.



Whose modifies the **subject** of this **adjective clause**.



7.5

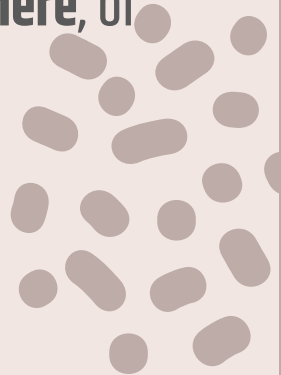
Adverb Clauses



7.5 Adverb Clauses

✎ An **adverb clause** is a **dependent clause** used in a sentence exactly like an **adverb**. It tells **when, where, how much, why, how often, or how soon** about the verb.

✎ An **adverb clause** begins with a **subordinating conjunction** such as **after, although, as, because, before, if, since, than, unless, until, when, where, or while**.



7.5 Adverb Clauses

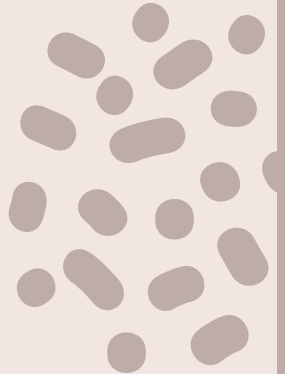
Mom helps you **when you ask her**.

In this example, the adverb clause **when you ask her** modifies the verb **helps**. It tells **when**. It is a **clause** because it has a **subject** (you) and a **verb** (ask).

More examples:

You wash the dishes **after we eat dinner**.

Max shoveled snow **until his arms ached**.

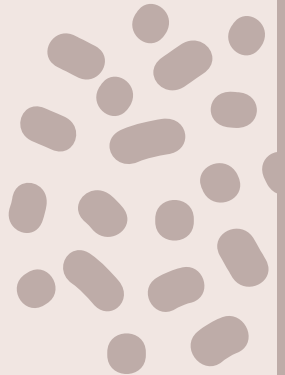


7.5 Adverb Clauses

✎ **Adverb clauses** can come at the **beginning** or at the **end** of a sentence. Usually, **commas** set off an **adverb clause** located at the **beginning** of a sentence.

When you ask, Mom will help you.

After we eat dinner, you wash the dishes.



7.5 Adverb Clauses

✎ An **adverb clause** may also answer questions about an **adjective** or another **adverb**. These **clauses** answer **questions** such as **how much**.

The weather was **warmer** **than we expected**.

The adverb clause **than we expected** modifies the adjective **warmer**. It tells **how much**.

The small boy ran **faster** **than I did**.

The adverb clause **than I did** modifies the adverb **faster**. It tells **how much**.



7.6

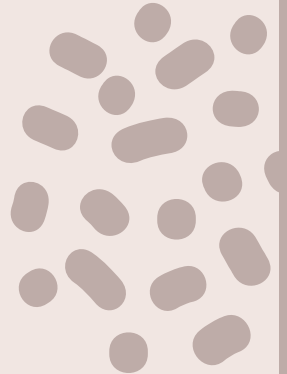
Diagramming Adverb Clauses



7.6 Diagramming Adverb Clauses

✎ Before we diagram an **adverb clause**, we must first **diagram** the **independent clause (main clause)**.

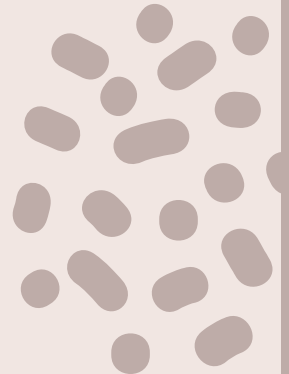
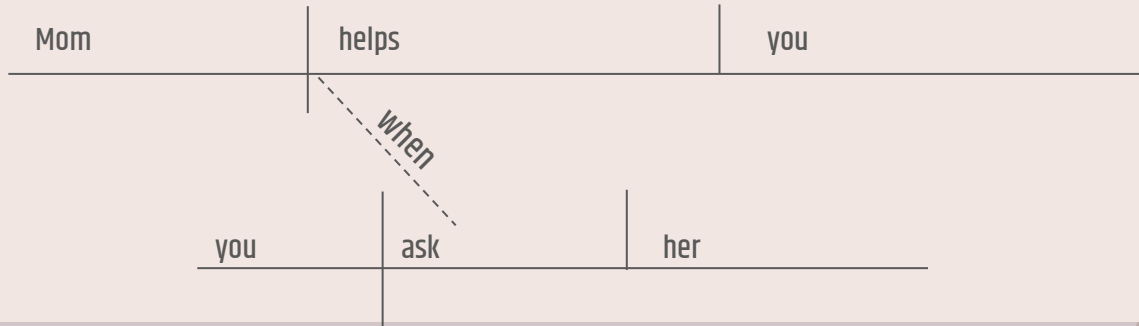
Mom helps you **when you ask her**.



7.6 Diagramming Adverb Clauses

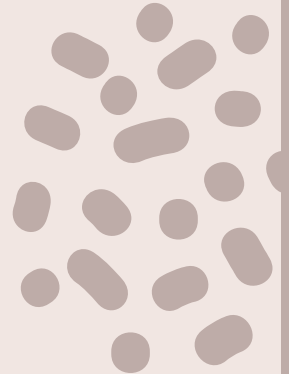
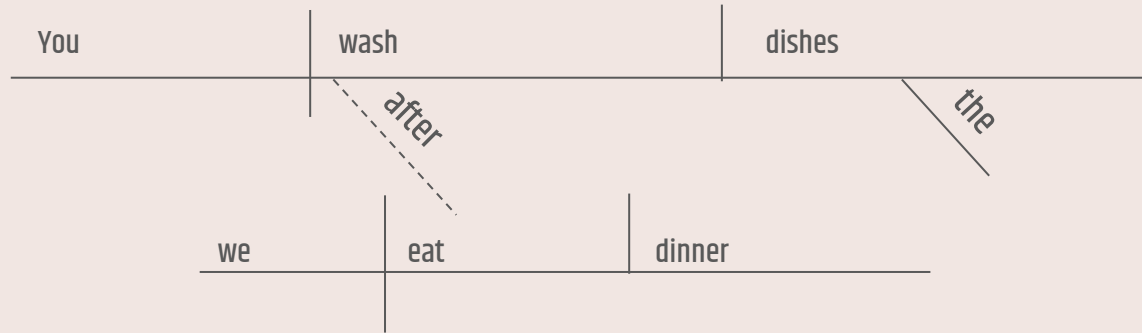
✎ The **adverb clause** is then diagrammed on a horizontal line below the **independent clause**. A dotted diagonal line connects the **verb** in the **adverb clause** to the word it modifies in the **independent clause**. The **subordinating conjunction** is written on the dotted diagonal line.

Mom helps you **when you ask her**.



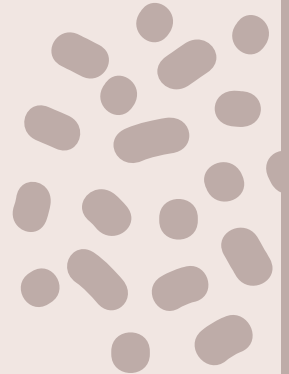
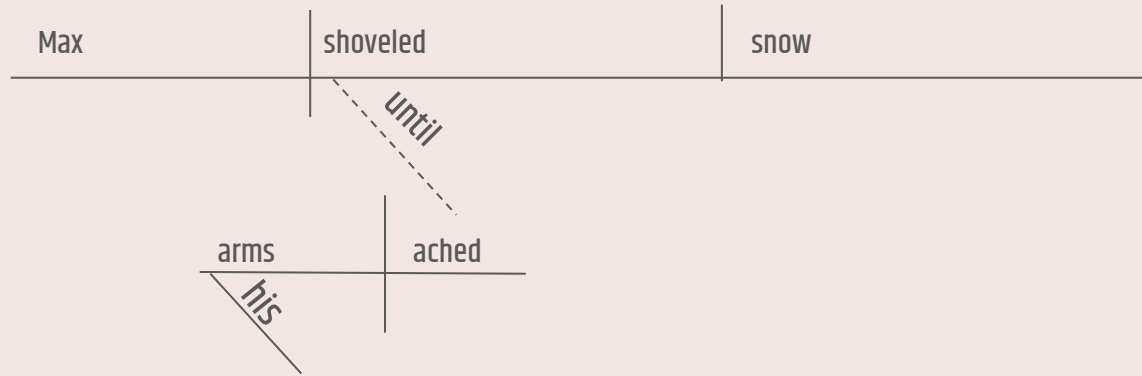
7.6 Diagramming Adverb Clauses

You wash the dishes **after we eat dinner**.



7.6 Diagramming Adverb Clauses

Max shoveled snow **until his arms ached**.



7.7

Noun Clauses



7.7 Noun Clauses

✎ A **noun clause** is a dependent clause used in a sentence as a **subject**, **direct object**, **predicate nominative**, **indirect object**, or **object of the preposition**.

✎ The words that generally introduce **noun clauses** are **how**, **if**, **that**, **what**, **whatever**, **when**, **whenever**, **where**, **wherever**, **whether**, **who**, **whoever**, **whom**, **whose**, and **why**.



7.7 Noun Clauses

✎ Subject:

Whoever borrowed my scarf returned it.

✎ Direct Object:

Dad described *what we caught in the pond*.

✎ Predicate Nominative:

Our concern was *where we would hike*.



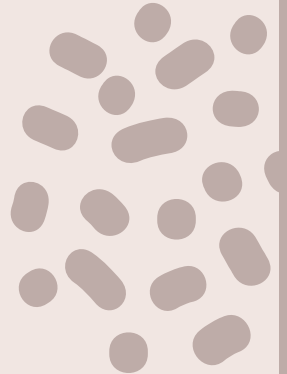
Practice

Discuss with the people around you and decide which sentence is functioning as a **subject**, **direct object**, and **predicate nominative**.

1. *A long vacation is **what our family needs**.* Predicate Nominative

2. ***What he said** astonished me.* Subject

3. *I will do **whatever you want**.* Direct Object



Next Year

*She was afraid **of what she might find**.*

In this example, the noun clause **of what she might find** is acting as the **object of the preposition** of the sentence.

*She told **whoever would listen** her sad story.*

In this example, the noun clause **whoever would listen** is acting as the **indirect object** of the sentence.

